

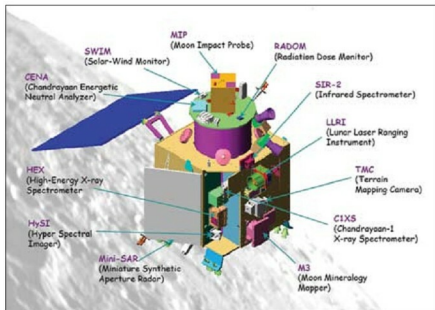


Fig. 3: The Chandrayaan-1 spacecraft

(CdZnTe) detector in the 30-250 keV energy region with spatial resolution of 40 km

5. Moon impact probe as piggy-back on the main orbiter of the Chandrayaan-1 spacecraft which impacted on the surface of the moon

The imported payloads on-board Chandrayaan-1 are:

1. Chandrayaan-1 X-ray spectrometer through ESA—a collaboration between Rutherford Appleton Laboratory, the UK and ISRO Satellite Centre, ISRO. Part of this payload was redesigned by the ISRO to suit scientific objectives of Chandrayaan-1

2. Near-infrared spectrometer (SIR-2) from Max Plank Institute, Lindau, Germany, through ESA

3. Sub-keV atom-reflecting analyser through ESA, from Swedish Institute of Space Physics, Sweden, and Space Physics Laboratory, Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre, ISRO. The data processing unit of this payload was designed and developed by the ISRO, while Swedish Institute of Space Physics developed the payload

4. Radiation-dose monitor from Bulgarian Academy of Sciences

5. Miniature synthetic aperture radar (MiniSAR) from Applied Physics Laboratory, Johns Hopkins University,

and Naval Air Warfare Centre, USA, through NASA

6. Moon mineralogy mapper from Brown University and Jet Propulsion Laboratory, USA, through NASA

Moon impact probe

The moon impact probe is slightly smaller than a TV cabinet and weighs a bit more than a school-going kid, but there's a lot tucked away inside it. The MIP detached from the Chandrayaan a 100 km above the moon. The 29kg moon impact probe—a payload developed by the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre at Thiruvananthapuram—will help identify future landing sites on the moon and also aid in scientific exploration of the lunar surface. The dimensions of the impact probe are 375×375×470 mm³.

The three major payloads in the MIP are:

1. Radar altimeter to measure the altitude of the moon impact probe above the lunar surface and qualify technologies for future landing missions. The operating frequency band is 4.3 GHz±100 MHz

2. Video imaging system to acquire images of the surface of the moon from the descending probe. The video imaging system consists of an ana-

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